



Identifying Language Features in Information Texts

Name: _____

Date: _____

Class: _____

Read the information text and highlight the language features.

Basketball: A Game of Speed, Skill and Teamwork

Basketball is a fast-paced team sport played by millions of people around the world. It is played indoors on a rectangular court with a hoop at each end. The goal is simple: score more points than the other team by shooting the ball through the opponent's basket.

The History of Basketball

Basketball was invented in 1891 by Dr. James Naismith, a Canadian physical education teacher. He created the game to keep students active during the winter months. The first game was played with a soccer ball and two peach baskets!

How the Game is Played

A team has five players on the court at a time. Players pass, dribble and shoot the ball to score. A standard game is played in four quarters, each lasting 10 or 12 minutes, depending on the level of play.

Scoring in Basketball

Points can be scored in different ways:

- 1 point – Free throw
- 2 points – Field goal (shot inside the three-point line)
- 3 points – Three-point shot (shot from behind the arc)

Key Skills in Basketball

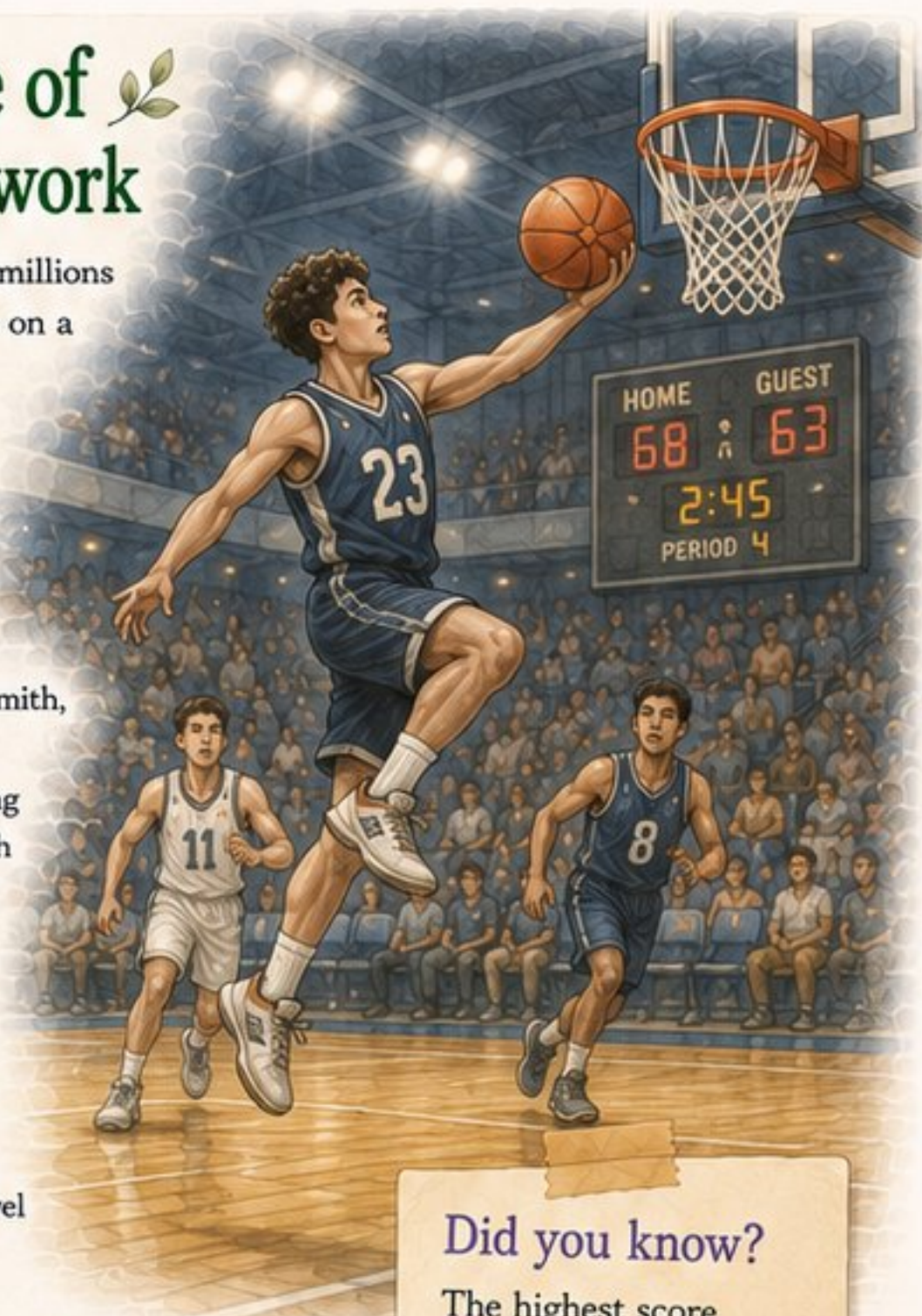
Basketball requires a combination of physical and mental skills.

Some of the most important skills include:

- Dribbling – Controlling the ball while moving.
- Passing – Getting the ball to a teammate.
- Shooting – Aiming and scoring points.
- Defence – Trying to stop the other team from scoring.

Why Basketball is Popular

Basketball is exciting to watch and fun to play. It promotes fitness, teamwork, discipline and sportsmanship. From local courts to the Olympics, basketball brings people of all ages and backgrounds together.



Did you know?

The highest score ever recorded in a professional game was 186–184! (Denver Nuggets vs Detroit Pistons, 1983)



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- Technical Vocabulary
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Mt Everest: Earth's Highest Peak

Mount Everest is the tallest mountain above sea level in the world. It is 8,848.86 metres high. Everest is part of the Himalayas, a huge mountain range in Asia. The mountain sits on the border between Nepal and Tibet (China). Its snow-covered peak reaches high into the clouds.

Where Is Mt Everest?

Mt Everest is located in the Himalayas. It is in Sagarmatha National Park in Nepal and Qomolangma National Nature Reserve in Tibet. The nearby town of Lukla in Nepal is a popular starting point for many climbers.

How Was Mt Everest Formed?

The Himalayas were formed about 50 million years ago. Tectonic plates under the Earth's surface pushed together, causing the land to fold and rise. Over millions of years, the land kept rising, and Mt Everest grew higher and higher.

Climbing Mt Everest

Climbing Everest is extremely dangerous and very challenging. The air is thin, the weather is unpredictable, and it is very cold. Climbers need special gear, training and determination. Most climbers spend weeks slowly climbing up and then a few days coming back down. Only experienced climbers attempt to reach the summit.

The First Ascent

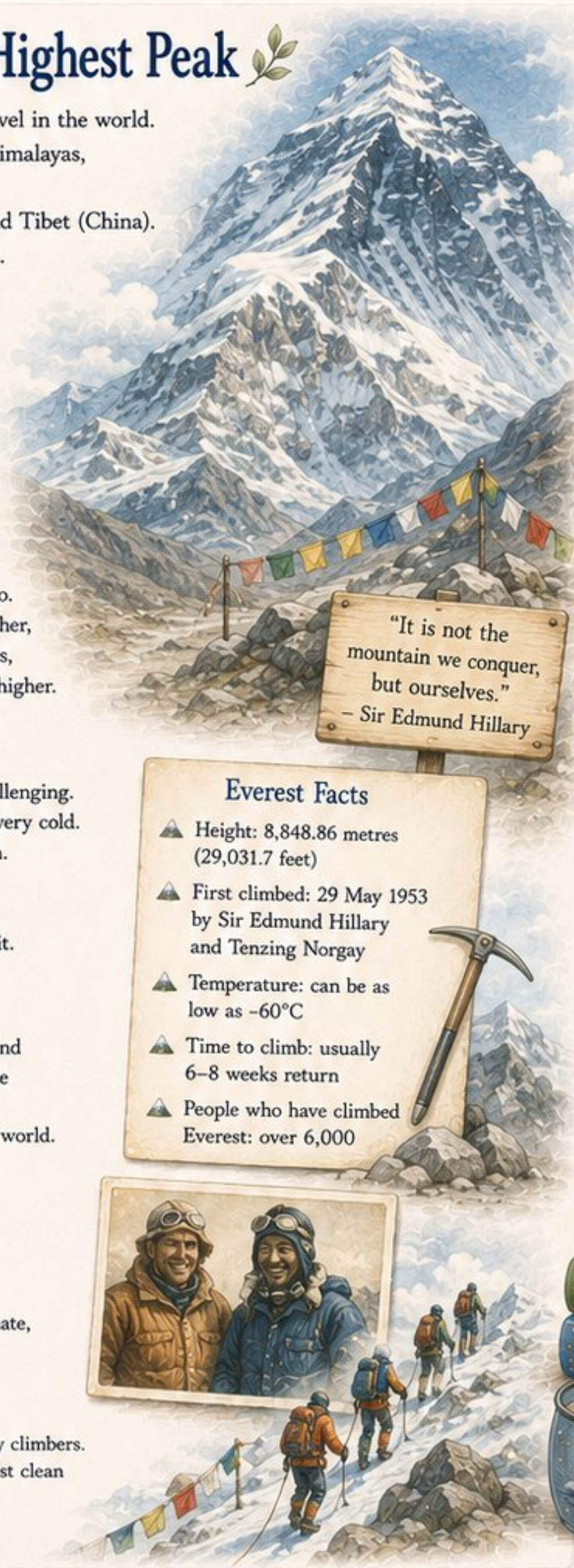
On 29 May 1953, Sir Edmund Hillary from New Zealand and Tenzing Norgay from Nepal became the first people to reach the summit of Mt Everest. Their amazing achievement inspired people around the world.

Why Is Mt Everest Important?

Mt Everest is more than just a mountain. It is a source of pride for Nepal and an important part of the culture and religion of local people. The mountain also attracts scientists who study the climate, ice and environment to help protect our planet.

Protecting Mt Everest

On 29, Mt Everest faces pollution and litter from too many climbers. People and organisations are working hard to keep Everest clean and protect this natural wonder for future generations. Everyone can help by respecting the mountain and leaving no trace behind.



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Cricket: A Game of Skill and Teamwork

Cricket is one of the world's most popular sports. It is played and watched by millions of people in many countries, especially in Australia, England, India, Pakistan, South Africa and New Zealand. Cricket is more than just a game—it is a sport that brings communities together.

What Is Cricket?

Cricket is a bat-and-ball game played between two teams of eleven players. One team bats, trying to score runs, while the other team fields, trying to get the batters "out". The team with the most runs at the end of the game wins.

How Is Cricket Played?

A match is played on a large oval field with a rectangular pitch in the middle. The main parts of the game are:

- **Batting:** Players score runs by hitting the ball and running between the wickets.
- **Bowling:** A bowler delivers the ball to the batter.
- **Fielding:** Fielders try to stop runs and take catches.
- **Wickets:** The bowler tries to hit the stumps with the ball to get the batter out.

Formats of the Game

Cricket can be played in different formats:

- **Test Match:** The longest format, played over five days.
- **One Day International (ODI):** Each team has 50 overs to bat.
- **Twenty20 (T20):** A fast and exciting format with only 20 overs per side.

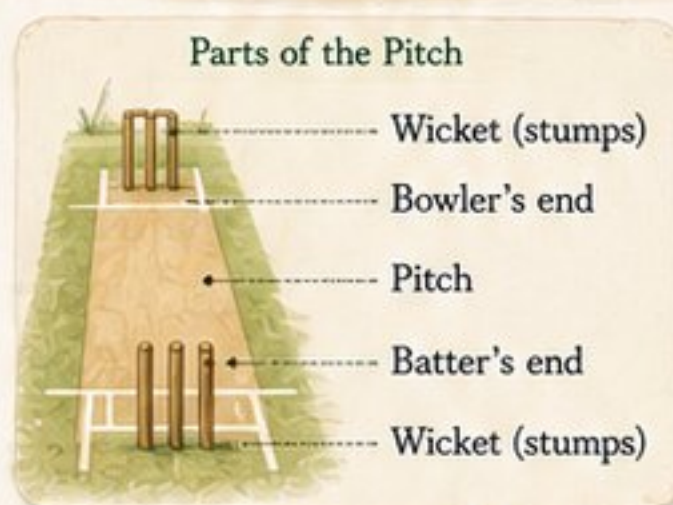
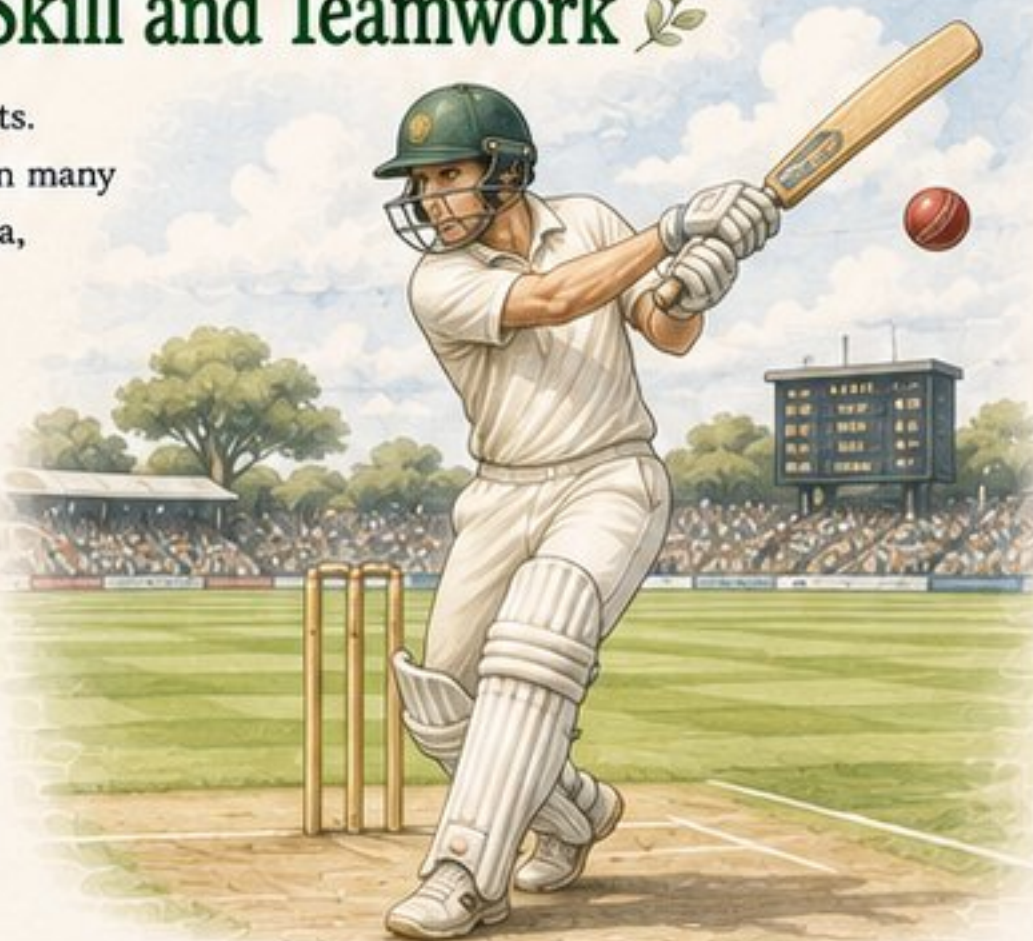
People of all ages enjoy watching and playing every format of the game.

Why Is Cricket Special?

Cricket takes skill, patience and strategy. It teaches players the importance of teamwork, respect and fair play. Whether it's played in a backyard, at the local park or in a huge stadium, cricket is a game that creates unforgettable moments and lifelong fans.

Fun Facts About Cricket

- The longest Test match in history lasted over 14 days!
- The fastest recorded ball in cricket was bowled at over 160 km/h.
- Cricket was the first sport to be broadcast live on television.
- The Cricket World Cup is one of the most-watched sporting events in the world.



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Healthy Eating: Fuel Your Body, Feel Your Best!

Food gives our bodies the energy and nutrients we need to grow, learn, play and stay healthy. Eating a variety of nutritious foods every day helps us feel good, think clearly and protects us from illness.

What Is Healthy Eating?

Healthy eating means choosing foods that give your body the right balance of nutrients. These include carbohydrates, protein, healthy fats, vitamins, minerals and water. No single food has everything we need, so it's important to eat a variety of foods from the different food groups.

The Five Food Groups

Australia's Guide to Healthy Eating shows us five food groups that help us get the nutrients we need every day:

- **Grains (cereals):** such as bread, rice, oats and wholegrain pasta. They give us energy.
- **Vegetables:** all types and colours. They are full of vitamins, minerals and fibre.
- **Fruit:** a great source of vitamins and natural sugars for energy.
- **Lean Proteins:** like chicken, fish, eggs, beans and tofu. They help build and repair body tissues.
- **Dairy or Alternatives:** like milk, yoghurt, cheese or calcium-rich alternatives. They help build strong bones and teeth.

Why Is Healthy Eating Important?

Eating well helps your body in many ways. It gives you energy to learn and play, helps you grow strong, supports your immune system and lowers the risk of many diseases, such as heart disease, type 2 diabetes and some cancers.

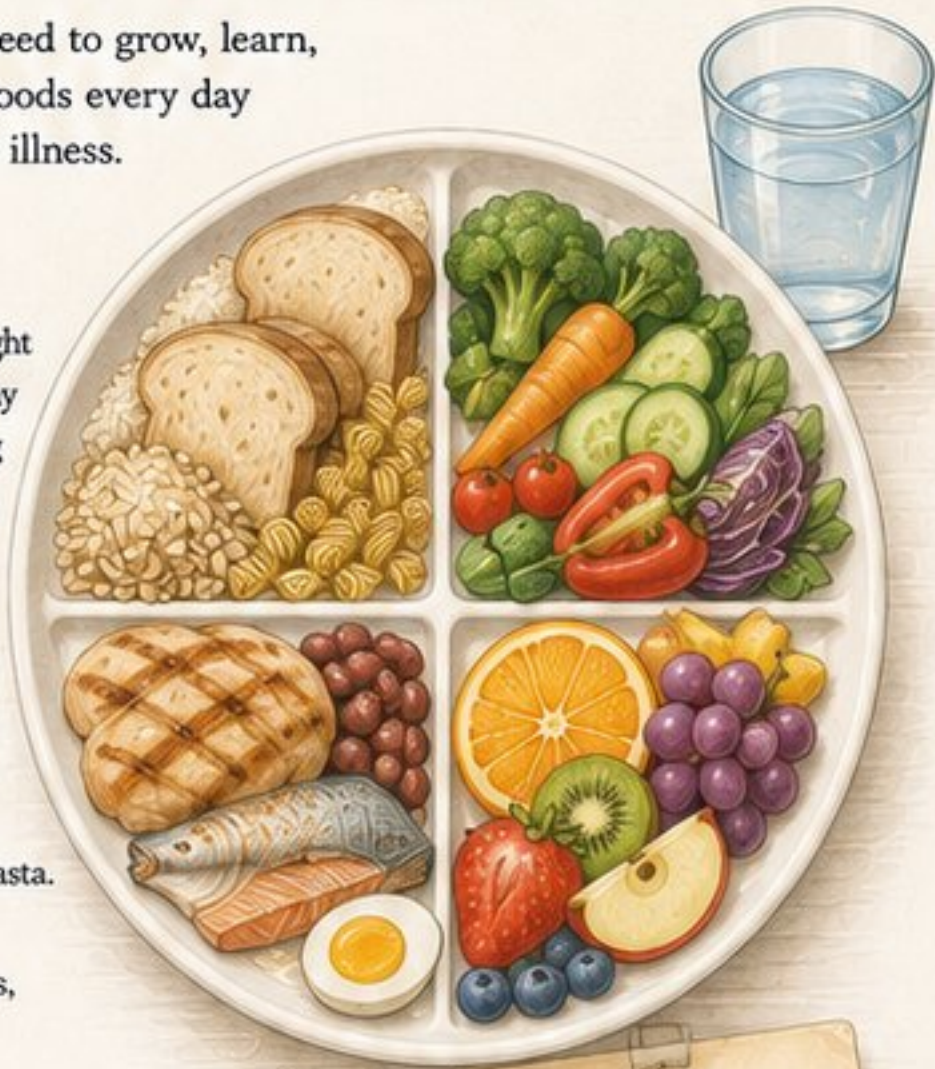
Tips for Healthy Eating

- Eat a variety of foods from all five food groups each day.
- Choose wholefoods over packaged or processed foods.
- Eat regular meals and healthy snacks.
- Drink plenty of water throughout the day.
- Limit foods high in added sugar, salt and unhealthy fats.

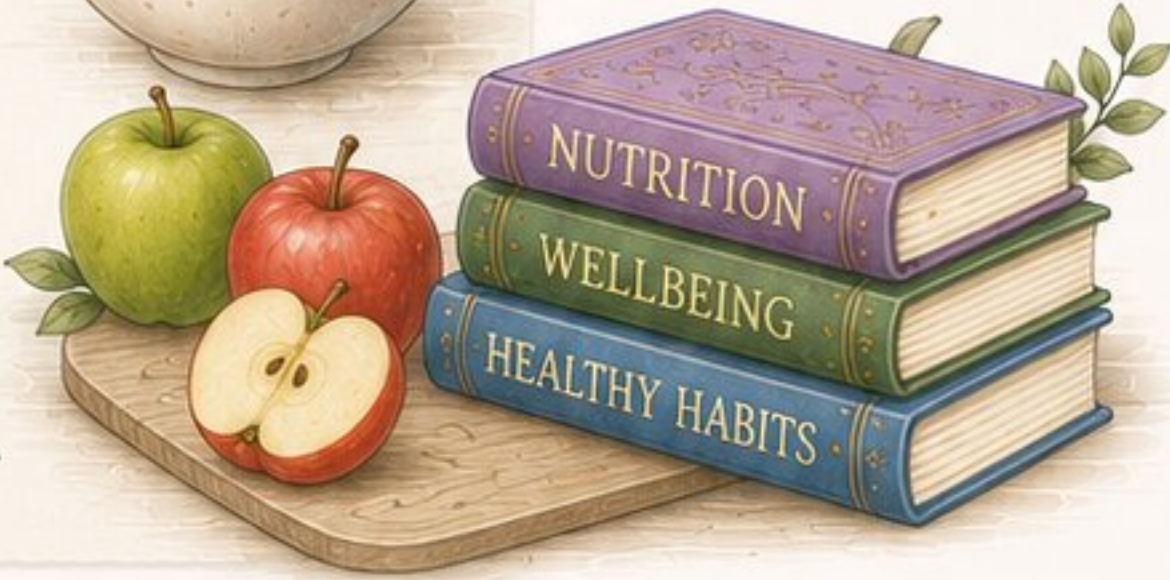
Making Healthy Choices

Healthy eating isn't about being perfect—it's about making better choices most of the time. Small changes can make a big difference. Start by adding more vegetables to your meals, choosing water instead of soft drinks and enjoying healthy foods with your family and friends.

Remember: Good food today means a healthier, happier you tomorrow! ❤️



Tip:
Try to drink plenty of water and limit sugary drinks. ❤️



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World War II: A Global Conflict

World War II was one of the most significant events in history. It lasted from 1939 to 1945 and involved the majority of the world's nations. More than 100 million people served in the military, and millions more were affected by the war. It changed the world forever.

What Caused World War II?

The war was caused by a combination of factors. After World War I, some countries were unhappy with the peace agreements. Economic problems, harsh treaties, and the rise of powerful leaders with extreme ideas led to tension. In 1939, Germany invaded Poland, and Britain and France declared war.

The Main Sides

The war was fought between two main groups.

- The Allies: led by Britain, the Soviet Union, the United States and their allies.
- The Axis Powers: led by Germany, Italy and Japan.

Many other countries joined one side or the other.

Major Events

Some important events shaped the outcome of the war.

- 1940: Germany invaded many countries in Europe.
- 1941: Japan attacked Pearl Harbor, drawing the USA into the war.
- 1942–1943: Key battles were fought in places like Stalingrad and El Alamein.
- 1944: D-Day – Allied forces invaded France to free Europe.
- 1945: Germany surrendered in May, and Japan surrendered in August after atomic bombs were dropped on Hiroshima and Nagasaki.

Life During the War

Life was very difficult for many people. Soldiers fought on land, at sea and in the air. Civilians faced food shortages, blackout nights and air raids. Many people were forced to leave their homes. Despite the hardships, people showed bravery and resilience.

The End of the War and Its Impact

After nearly six years, the war came to an end. The United Nations was formed to promote peace and cooperation. Many countries worked to rebuild their cities and support those affected. World War II taught the world important lessons about peace, freedom and human rights.



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Dinosaurs: Giants of the Ancient World

Dinosaurs lived on Earth millions of years ago. They ruled the land for over 160 million years, long before humans ever existed. From tiny creatures no bigger than a chicken to giant herbivores longer than a bus, dinosaurs came in many shapes and sizes!

What Are Dinosaurs?

Dinosaurs are a group of reptiles. They were different from other reptiles because many walked on two legs, had upright posture, and laid eggs with hard shells. Scientists believe birds are actually a type of dinosaur!

When Did Dinosaurs Live?

Dinosaurs lived during the Mesozoic Era, also known as the “Age of Dinosaurs.” This era is divided into three periods:

- Triassic Period (about 252 to 201 million years ago)
- Jurassic Period (about 201 to 145 million years ago)
- Cretaceous Period (about 145 to 66 million years ago)

Dinosaurs became extinct about 66 million years ago.

Types of Dinosaurs

Dinosaurs can be grouped into two main categories:

- Carnivores – meat-eaters, with sharp teeth and claws. Examples include Tyrannosaurus rex and Velociraptor.
- Herbivores – plant-eaters, with flat teeth and long necks or tails. Examples include Brachiosaurus and Triceratops.

How Do We Know About Dinosaurs?

Scientists discover dinosaur fossils—bones, teeth, footprints and eggs—buried in rock. They carefully dig them out and study them to learn about how dinosaurs lived, what they ate, and how they moved.

Why Did Dinosaurs Become Extinct?

Scientists believe a huge asteroid hit Earth, causing massive changes to the climate. This led to the loss of plants and food, and many dinosaurs could not survive. Although dinosaurs are extinct, their story continues to fascinate us!



Did you know?

The word “dinosaur” means “terrible lizard” in Greek!



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Insects: Small Creatures, Big Impact!

Insects are the most diverse group of animals on Earth. There are more than one million different species of insects, and they can be found almost everywhere—from rainforests and deserts to your backyard!

What Are Insects?

Insects are invertebrates, which means they do not have a backbone. All insects have three main body parts: a head, a thorax (middle) and an abdomen (bottom). They also have six legs, two antennae, and most have wings.

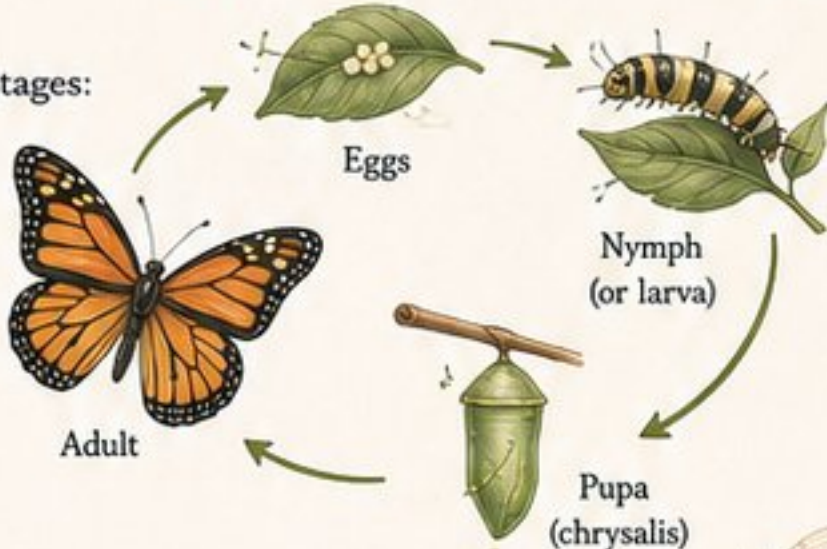
Types of Insects

Insects come in many shapes, sizes and colours. Some common groups include:

- Beetles – hard wing covers protect their bodies.
- Butterflies and moths – known for their colourful wings.
- Ants – live in large groups called colonies.
- Grasshoppers – strong back legs help them jump.
- Bees – important pollinators that help plants grow.

Life Cycle of an Insect

Many insects go through a life cycle with four stages: egg, nymph (or larva), pupa and adult. This amazing transformation is called metamorphosis. For example, a butterfly starts as a tiny egg, hatches into a caterpillar, forms a chrysalis (pupa), and finally emerges as a beautiful butterfly!



Why Are Insects Important?

Insects play a huge role in keeping our world healthy.

- They pollinate flowers and crops, which helps produce food.
- They break down dead plants and animals, recycling nutrients in soil.
- They are food for many other animals, such as birds, frogs and bats.

Without insects, many plants and animals—including humans—would struggle to survive.

Protecting Insects

Sadly, insects are in danger due to habitat loss, pollution and pesticides.

We can help by planting native plants, reducing chemicals, and protecting natural habitats. Even small actions can make a big difference for these tiny creatures with a huge impact!

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Exploring Space: *The Final Frontier*

Space is the vast area that exists beyond Earth's atmosphere. It is filled with planets, stars, galaxies, moons, asteroids, comets and mysterious dark matter. For centuries, humans have looked up at the night sky with wonder—and today, we are exploring it like never before.

What Is in Space?

Our solar system has eight planets that orbit the Sun: Mercury, Venus, Earth, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus and Neptune. Beyond our solar system are billions of galaxies, each containing billions of stars. Some stars are tiny and cool, while others are enormous and super hot! Black holes, neutron stars and pulsars are just some of the fascinating objects scientists have discovered.

How Do We Explore Space?

We explore space using telescopes, satellites, space probes and rockets. Telescopes like the Hubble Space Telescope help us see distant stars and galaxies. Satellites orbit Earth and collect important data about our planet and the universe. Space probes, such as Voyager and Perseverance, travel far beyond Earth to gather information. Astronauts also explore space by living and working on the International Space Station (ISS).

Why Is Space Exploration Important?

Studying space helps us learn more about our universe and our place in it. It leads to new technologies, creates jobs and inspires future scientists and engineers. It also helps us understand Earth better—such as how to protect it from asteroids and how other planets might support life.

The Future of Space

The future is full of exciting possibilities! Scientists are planning missions to Mars, building new telescopes to look deeper into space, and even thinking about living on the Moon one day. The universe is full of secrets, and we have only just begun our journey to discover them.

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Sea Turtles: Ocean Survivors

Ancient travellers of the deep

What Are Sea Turtles?

Sea turtles are large, air-breathing reptiles that live in the ocean. They belong to a group of animals called chelonians, which also includes tortoises and freshwater turtles. Unlike fish, sea turtles have lungs, so they must come to the surface to breathe air.

Species and Size

There are seven species of sea turtles in the world: the green, loggerhead, hawksbill, leatherback, olive ridley, Kemp's ridley and flatback. The largest of all is the leatherback, which can grow to around 2 metres long and weigh more than 600 kilograms. In comparison, the smallest, the Kemp's ridley, usually grows to about 70 centimetres and weighs around 45 kilograms.

Life Cycle

Sea turtles can live for 50 to 100 years, making them one of the longest-living reptiles on Earth. Most female sea turtles return to the same beach where they hatched to lay their own eggs. During the nesting season, females dig deep holes in the sand, called nests, and can lay up to 120 eggs at a time. After about 45 to 70 days, the tiny hatchlings break free from their eggs and make a dangerous dash across the beach to the ocean, guided by the bright light of the moon. Only about 1 in 1,000 hatchlings survive to adulthood.

What Do Sea Turtles Eat?

The diet of sea turtles depends on the species. Green turtles mainly eat seagrass and seaweed, while hawksbills prefer sponges found on coral reefs. Loggerheads feed on crabs, jellyfish and other shellfish. Each species plays an important role in keeping the ocean habitats healthy and balanced.

Threats and Conservation

Sadly, sea turtles are endangered. They face many threats, including plastic pollution, illegal hunting, and loss of nesting beaches due to coastal development. It's estimated that over 100 million marine animals, including turtles, are killed each year by plastic in the ocean. People can help by reducing single-use plastics, keeping beaches clean, and supporting conservation programs that protect nesting sites.

Healthy oceans
=
healthy sea turtles!

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The Amazing World of Bees

Bees are small insects, but they play a very big role in our world. Without bees, many of the foods we eat—like apples, almonds and blueberries—would be much harder to grow.

What Are Bees?

Bees belong to a group of insects called pollinators. There are over 20,000 different kinds of bees in the world! The most well-known is the honeybee. Bees have three main body parts: a head, a thorax (middle), and an abdomen (bottom). They have six legs, two antennae, and in most cases, two pairs of wings. Female bees have a stinger they use for protection.

Where Do Bees Live?

Bees live in hives or colonies. A honeybee colony can have thousands of bees! The hive is like their home, where they work together to survive. Inside the hive, there are different jobs for different bees.

What Do Bees Do?

The main job of bees is to collect nectar and pollen from flowers. As they move from flower to flower, pollen sticks to their bodies. Bees then carry this pollen to other flowers, helping plants grow. This process is called pollination. Bees also make honey from the nectar they collect.

Why Are Bees Important?

Bees help pollinate many plants that humans rely on for food. In fact, one out of every three mouthfuls of food we eat exists because of pollinators like bees! Sadly, bees are in danger due to habitat loss, pollution, and pesticides. We can help by planting native flowers, avoiding harmful chemicals, and supporting local beekeepers.



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